

Gen-AI Log Guide

Purpose

During this lab, you are allowed and encouraged to use AI tools such as ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot, Cursor, or other AI assistants.

At the end of the lab, you will submit an **AI Usage Log** documenting how you used AI during your work.

The purpose of this log is to help the instructors understand your **problem-solving process and effort**, including how you interacted with AI while completing the lab.

This is **not intended to be a test of whether you used AI**. You should honestly document your interactions.

Step 1 — Use AI normally

Work on the lab as you normally would.

You may use any AI assistant that is useful to you, including:

- ChatGPT
- Claude
- Gemini
- GitHub Copilot
- Cursor
- VS Code AI assistants
- Other AI coding assistants

Ask questions, request explanations, get debugging help, have code reviewed, discuss possible approaches, etc.

Do not worry about creating the log while you work.

Just complete the lab normally.

Step 2 — Get the AI Usage Log instructions

At the end of your work, use the file provided by your instructor:

AI_USAGE_LOG_INSTRUCTIONS.md

Give this file (or its contents) to the AI assistant you used **in the same chat**.

Step 3 — Ask the AI to generate the log

Your AI assistant should generate a Markdown document beginning with:

```
# AI Usage Log
```

The document should contain entries similar to:

```
## Interaction 1
```

```
### User
```

```
Why does my program crash when the input is empty?
```

```
### Assistant Summary
```

Step 4 — If the AI creates ai_usage_log.md

Some AI platforms can create files directly.

If your AI assistant gives you a file named:

ai_usage_log.md

Step 5 — If the AI only gives you Markdown text

Some AI assistants will display the completed Markdown directly in the chat instead of creating a downloadable file.

That's okay.

Use the course's **AI Usage Log Converter**:

[AI Usage Log Converter](#)

On the converter page:

1. Copy the complete Markdown generated by your AI.
2. Paste it into the **AI-generated Markdown** box.
3. Click **Download ai_usage_log.md**.
4. Save the downloaded file.

The converter creates the required file:

```
ai_usage_log.md
```

Step 6 — Submit the file

Submit:

```
ai_usage_log.md
```

Important Notes

Do not worry about formatting the Markdown

If the AI generates the correct Markdown structure, simply copy it into the converter if necessary.

Be honest

The purpose of the log is to document how you worked with AI.

It is not necessary to make your AI usage look a certain way. Questions, failed attempts, debugging, misunderstandings, corrections, and back-and-forth discussions are all legitimate parts of the process.

Keep your original AI conversation

Do not delete your AI conversation before generating the log. The AI needs access to the conversation history in order to document it.